

Data Flow Diagrams

A Data Flow Diagram (DFD) is a visual representation of information flows within a system. For Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow, it shows how incident data enters the system, is processed, stored, and delivered to users and support teams.

DFD Level 0 – Incident Lifecycle Automation

Flow: IT User → Incident Creation → Classification & Priority → Assignment → Investigation → SLA Monitoring / Escalation → Resolution → Closure → User Notification

User Stories

The following user stories define the major functional requirements for the Incident Lifecycle Automation solution.

Key Users / Actors

IT User / Customer – reports incidents and monitors status.

Service Desk / Agent – classifies, prioritizes and assigns incidents.

Support Technician – investigates, updates and resolves incidents.

ServiceNow System – automates SLA monitoring, notifications and escalation.

Administrator – maintains configuration and lifecycle rules.

Expected Outcome

The DFD and user stories provide a clear view of the Incident Lifecycle Automation requirements and define the functions needed for incident creation, classification, prioritization, assignment, investigation, SLA monitoring, escalation, notification, resolution and closure.

Date	5 September 2026
Team ID	_____
Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Source / Actor	ServiceNow Process	Output / Destination
IT User / Customer	Create incident with issue details	Incident record
ServiceNow	Classify incident and determine impact, urgency and priority	Prioritized incident
ServiceNow	Assign to appropriate support group / technician	Assigned incident
Support Technician	Investigate and update work notes	Investigation updates
ServiceNow	Monitor SLA and trigger escalation/notifications	Alerts / escalations
Support Technician	Record resolution	Resolution details
ServiceNow	Close incident and retain history	Closed incident / history
IT User / Customer	Receive status and resolution updates	Closure confirmation

User Type	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Release
IT User / Customer	Incident Management	USN-1	As an IT user, I can create an incident by providing the required issue details.	Incident is created with the submitted information.	High	Sprint-1

User Type	Functional Requirement (Epic)	User Story Number	User Story / Task	Acceptance Criteria	Priority	Release
IT User / Customer	Incident Management	USN-2	As an IT user, I can view the status of my incident.	Current incident state and progress are visible.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk / Agent	Classification	USN-3	As an agent, I can classify an incident using category and subcategory.	Classification is saved correctly.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk / Agent	Priority	USN-4	As an agent, I can determine priority using impact and urgency.	Appropriate priority is assigned.	High	Sprint-1
Service Desk / Agent	Assignment	USN-5	As an agent, I can assign an incident to the appropriate assignment group.	Incident is routed to the correct group.	High	Sprint-1
Support Technician	Investigation	USN-6	As a technician, I can assign an incident to myself when responsible for it.	Assigned-to field shows the technician.	Medium	Sprint-1
Support Technician	Investigation	USN-7	As a technician, I can add work notes and update the incident.	Updates are saved in activity history.	High	Sprint-1
ServiceNow System	SLA Monitoring	USN-8	As the ServiceNow system, I can monitor incident SLA progress.	SLA status and elapsed time are tracked.	High	Sprint-2
ServiceNow System	Escalation	USN-9	As the ServiceNow system, I can escalate incidents when SLA or priority conditions are met.	Escalation/notification is triggered.	High	Sprint-2
IT User / Customer	Notifications	USN-10	As an IT user, I can receive notifications about important incident updates.	Configured notifications are received.	Medium	Sprint-2
Support Technician	Resolution	USN-11	As a technician, I can record incident resolution details.	Resolution is captured before closure.	High	Sprint-2
Administrator	Closure	USN-12	As an administrator, I can ensure incidents follow the defined closure process.	Only eligible incidents are closed.	Medium	Sprint-2